



MICHAL WALUSZA

Koneru Humpy made up for a slow start in the second half of her campaign to share the second spot. Given her experience and head-to-head record

against those in the field, the 37-year-old was expected to do better. But she deserves all credit for giving it her all despite struggling with form.

Points scored – 7.5/14

Rd	Seed	Opponent	Country	Rating	Colour	Result	Rank
1	7	R. Vaishali	India	2475	Black	Draw	Tied 2nd
2	4	Kateryna Lagno	FIDE	2542	Black	Draw	6th
3	5	Tan Zhongyi	China	2521	White	Draw	1st
4	8	Nurgyul Salimova	Bulgaria	2432	Black	Lost	Tied 7th
5	1	Aleksandra Goryachkina	FIDE	2553	White	Draw	5th
6	2	Lei Tingjie	China	2550	White	Lost	Tied 2nd
7	6	Anna Muzychuk	Ukraine	2520	Black	Draw	Tied 7th
8	7	R. Vaishali	India	2475	White	Won	Tied 2nd
9	4	Kateryna Lagno	FIDE	2542	White	Draw	6th
10	5	Tan Zhongyi	China	2521	Black	Draw	1st
11	8	Nurgyul Salimova	Bulgaria	2432	White	Won	Tied 7th
12	1	Aleksandra Goryachkina	FIDE	2553	Black	Draw	5th
13	6	Anna Muzychuk	Ukraine	2520	White	Draw	Tied 7th
14	2	Lei Tingjie	China	2550	Black	Won	Tied 2nd

In the first half of seven rounds, Humpy was not only winless but suffered a loss to the lowest-rated Bulgarian Nurgyul Salimova in the fourth round and to second-seeded Chinese Lei Tingjie in the sixth.

However, it was in the second half that Humpy's determination came to the fore. She resurrected her campaign by not only staying unbeaten but also scoring over compatriot R. Vaishali, avenging the loss to Salimova, and finishing her campaign by beating second seed and defending champion, Lei Tingjie. This triumph saw her match Lei's tally and finish joint runner-up, before Vaishali joined the duo.

It is creditable that, despite lacking the cutting edge for the better part of the Candidates, Humpy could draw from her vast experience to bounce back.

Though champion Tan Zhongyi, who never trailed, went beyond the reach of the other contender towards the closing stages, Humpy did extremely well to occupy the next best spot.

Koneru Humpy

Rank

Tied 2nd

Seeding

3

Rating

2546

Performance Rating

2542

Rating points lost

1.4